

Given that your music is stored in various compression formats (MP3, AAC, WMA, OGG, etc.) on various locations on your hard drive it becomes almost a necessity to have some sort of ‘arrangement’ to your music files. Whether you’re ripping music off CDs or downloading it off the Internet, unless you’re an uber-geek, it’s unlikely that you’re keeping it sorted by artist/album/track number. So how exactly do you keep Madonna in one place, Kylie in another, and *still* manage to find them on your computer instantly? Read on...

10.1 Playlists: The Traditional Way

As the name suggests, a Playlist is a list of songs that are arranged in an order to be played. And essentially, that’s about as far as a Playlist will go in arranging your music. At the time when media players were being introduced on personal computers, Playlists became an efficient way to keep one’s music organised. The most popular formats of Playlists (.m3u and .pls) are basically lists of locations of various media files on your computer. So when you load a Playlist you are giving your media player an address book of your media files.

The advantage of maintaining music on Playlists is that you can make them specific to artist, mood, genre, year, or whatever grouping you want. Playlists can also be made so that your music files play in a particular order that you decide.

10.1.1 Making a Playlist

Playlists can be made using practically any media player. For the purpose of demonstration, we have used Windows Media Player (WMP).

1. Drop all the music files you want in the Playlist into the ‘Now Playing List’ at the right of the ‘Now Playing’ screen of WMP.
2. Order them in the arrangement of your choice by keeping the left mouse button pressed on the song you want and dragging it up or down the list.